

THE UNTOLD MISERY OF MALE ABANDONED CALVES IN INDIA

A seasonal visual awareness document on suffering, causes, practical solutions and compassionate rescue.

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THE UNTOLD MISERY OF MALE ABANDONED CALVES IN INDIA

He is not just a calf... He is a living soul... A part of our Dharma...

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**Think
Feel
Act**

SUMMER

HEAT, THIRST & SUFFERING

Scorching heat burns his fragile body.

No water, no shade, no one to care.

Dehydration, weakness and often serious illness.

He just wants a little water and love.

He feels the heat too...

RAINY SEASON

COLD, WET & DISEASES

Gets drenched in heavy rain.

No shelter, no dry place to rest.

Falls sick with fever, cough, skin infection, foot rot and other diseases.

Shivering, hungry and alone.

He shivers in the rain...

WINTER

COLD, HUNGER & HOPELESSNESS

Bone-chilling cold, no warm shelter.

Wind, fog and frost make it worse.

Lack of proper food and nutrition.

He dreams of warmth, care and a family but gets only neglect.

He longs for warmth...

WHY?

THE REASON BEHIND HIS ABANDONMENT

- Male calves are often seen as “not useful” for milk, so they are neglected or abandoned.
- Economic pressure, lack of awareness and shallow traditions.
- Illegal dairy practices and commercial greed.
- Loss of faith in cattle care and dharma.
- This is not just an animal issue, it is a social and cultural failure.

He was born innocent... not to be abandoned!

A calf is not a product...
He is a part of our culture, our karma, our future.

SOLUTIONS

BY COMMON MEN & GOVERNMENT

WHAT CAN WE DO
(As Common Men / Society)

- Adopt and support abandoned calves.
- Provide food, water and shelter.
- Create awareness in our communities.
- Stop illegal transport and slaughter.
- Support cow shelters (Gaushalas) and local animal care groups.
- Choose compassion over convenience.

Small actions create big change!

WHAT GOVERNMENT CAN DO

- Strictly enforce animal protection laws and stop illegal trade.
- Increase funding for Gaushalas and rescue centers.
- Provide veterinary care and mobile clinics in rural areas.
- Run awareness programs in schools and villages.
- Ensure better policies for abandoned and stray animals.
- Support NGOs and rescue organizations with resources.

Strong laws + Active support = A kinder India

ALTERNATE SOLUTIONS

BY RESCUERS & CAREGIVERS

They don't just save animals...
They save lives — including humans.

- Rescue abandoned calves, bring them to shelters and provide proper food, water and care.
- Arrange medical treatment and rehabilitation.
- Adopt a vegan lifestyle and promote compassion for all living beings.
- Dedicate their time, money and life for animal welfare, often without recognition.
- Many also help the needy humans — old, sick, poor and helpless.
- They are the real heroes of our society, walking examples of true humanity.

Their sacrifice is our inspiration...

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SAVE MALE CALVES • SAVE DHARMA • SAVE COMPASSION • SAVE INDIA

Think about him... Choose compassion... Be the change...

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Jai Gau Mata | Jai Bharat

Think • Feel • Act — Compassion can begin with one living being in front of us.

1. WHY THIS DOCUMENT MATTERS

An abandoned calf is a living, vulnerable animal whose needs do not disappear because it has little or no commercial value. Heat, rain, cold, hunger, traffic, disease and lack of shelter can combine to create severe welfare risks.

This expanded guide explains the six-panel poster in practical terms. It recognizes that cattle welfare involves owners, farmers, families, communities, veterinarians, shelters, rescuers and public authorities.

Possible causes

- Perceived low economic value of some male calves in production systems.
- Economic pressure and the cost of feed, treatment, transport or shelter.
- Limited access to veterinary services, rescue transport or safe temporary housing.
- Poor animal-management practices or inadequate planning for unwanted animals.
- Neglect or abandonment that leaves an animal exposed to weather, traffic, hunger and disease.
- Gaps in coordination between citizens, caregivers, shelters and authorities.

Important distinction

These are possible contributing pressures, not a claim that every farmer, owner or community treats male calves alike. The welfare response should focus on the individual animal's immediate needs and on preventing future abandonment.

A calf is not merely a product. It is a living being capable of experiencing comfort, fear, hunger, pain and relief.

2. SUMMER — HEAT, THIRST & DEHYDRATION

Extreme heat can rapidly increase welfare risks, particularly when clean water, shade and ventilation are unavailable.

Key welfare risks

- Heat stress and dehydration can cause weakness and reduce the animal's ability to cope with other illness.
- Direct sun and hot ground can make resting difficult for a weak calf.
- Severe dehydration or collapse requires prompt professional attention.
- Roadside exposure adds traffic, dust and injury risks.

Practical response

- Provide safe access to clean drinking water where appropriate.
- Provide shade and a cool, ventilated resting area.
- Seek veterinary help if the calf is severely weak, collapsed, injured or unable to drink.
- Avoid unsafe roadside handling or unplanned relocation.

Seasonal reminder: prevention, early observation and timely care can reduce suffering.

3. RAINY SEASON — COLD, WETNESS & INFECTION RISK

Monsoon conditions can leave an exposed calf wet, muddy and unable to find a clean resting place.

Key welfare risks

- Prolonged wetness can contribute to chilling and skin problems.
- Mud and contaminated surroundings make hygiene and feeding more difficult.
- Standing water can create additional environmental hazards.
- A weakened calf may become less able to feed, stand or escape danger.

Practical response

- Provide a dry, roofed and well-drained resting area.
- Keep feeding and watering areas clean.
- Seek veterinary advice for persistent cough, diarrhea, skin lesions, severe weakness or inability to stand.
- Ensure rescue transport and temporary shelter remain dry and ventilated.

Seasonal reminder: prevention, early observation and timely care can reduce suffering.

4. WINTER — COLD, HUNGER & EXPOSURE

Cold weather can be particularly challenging for a young, undernourished or sick calf.

Key welfare risks

- Cold wind, fog, damp bedding and prolonged exposure can increase discomfort.
- Insufficient nutrition can leave a vulnerable animal with less energy to cope with cold.
- Illness or injury may require veterinary assessment rather than simple outdoor shelter.
- Roadside exposure can combine cold stress with traffic and other physical hazards.

Practical response

- Provide dry bedding and protection from cold wind while maintaining ventilation.
- Arrange appropriate nutrition with veterinary guidance when needed.
- Keep young or weakened animals under regular observation.
- Coordinate with a credible shelter, veterinarian, rescuer or local authority for longer-term care.

Seasonal reminder: prevention, early observation and timely care can reduce suffering.

5. WHY CAN MALE CALVES BECOME ABANDONED OR NEGLECTED?

The “WHY?” panel is best understood as a set of possible social, economic and management pressures rather than a universal explanation.

- Perceived low economic value: in some dairy-oriented systems, male calves may be regarded as less economically useful.
- Economic constraints: feed, treatment, transport and shelter can be difficult costs for financially stressed owners.
- Service gaps: veterinary care, rescue transport, temporary shelter and reliable information may not be readily accessible everywhere.
- Poor management: inadequate feeding, housing, identification or planning can allow a calf to deteriorate.
- Abandonment: releasing an animal without a responsible care arrangement can expose it to hunger, traffic, weather and disease.
- Weak coordination: delays can occur when citizens, shelters, veterinarians and authorities do not have a clear response pathway.

Long-term objective

The aim should be more than rescuing animals after a crisis. Prevention requires responsible ownership, better access to veterinary and shelter services, humane animal-management practices, awareness and coordinated local response.

6. SOLUTIONS — COMMON PEOPLE & GOVERNMENT

What common people can do

- Check immediate danger: traffic, injury, entanglement, extreme weather or inability to stand.
- Provide safe access to water and, where appropriate, suitable food; do not force risky substances or treatments.
- Contact a veterinarian or credible rescue service for a weak, injured, sick or very young calf.
- Do not simply dump or relocate an animal to another roadside location.
- Support legitimate shelters and caregivers through verified donations, food, transport, equipment or volunteering.
- Encourage responsible animal ownership and humane treatment in the community.

What government and public systems can do

- Strengthen implementation of applicable animal-welfare and cattle-management laws and local rules.
- Improve veterinary access, emergency response, vaccination and treatment services where needed.
- Support properly managed shelters and rescue infrastructure with transparent standards and oversight.
- Develop local response mechanisms connecting citizens, veterinarians, shelters and authorities.
- Promote awareness in villages, schools, markets and cattle-owning communities.
- Support transparent monitoring and evidence-based welfare planning.

Strong systems + responsible citizens = faster, safer welfare response.

7. ALTERNATE SOLUTIONS — RESCUERS & CAREGIVERS

Rescuers and caregivers often intervene where ordinary support systems have failed. Their work can involve safe handling, transport, temporary shelter, feeding, veterinary coordination, rehabilitation, documentation and long-term care.

Immediate rescue pathway

- Secure the scene and protect both the animal and people from immediate hazards.
- Observe urgent needs without attempting procedures beyond the rescuer's competence.
- Arrange veterinary examination for suspected illness, injury, severe weakness, dehydration or inability to stand.
- Provide a clean, dry, ventilated and secure temporary space.
- Maintain basic records such as location, date, condition, treatment and transfer details.
- Coordinate responsible placement rather than abandoning the animal again.

Beyond emergency rescue

- Build local networks of verified caregivers, veterinarians, transporters and shelters.
- Prepare season-specific plans for water and shade, monsoon shelter, drainage and winter bedding.
- Prioritize prevention and rehabilitation, not only crisis response.
- Use transparent fundraising and records so public support reaches genuine animal-care needs.
- Promote compassion for vulnerable living beings while keeping rescue work safe, lawful and sustainable.
- Where possible, extend the same ethic of service to other vulnerable animals and people in need.

A caregiver's sacrifice becomes stronger when compassion is joined with knowledge, discipline, safety, cooperation and sustainable care.

8. COMMUNITY ACTION CHECKLIST

Situation	Immediate response	Next step
Traffic / immediate danger	Create distance from danger if safely possible.	Contact appropriate local rescue or authority support.
Weak / sick calf	Provide a calm, safe place; avoid unsafe treatment.	Seek veterinary assessment promptly.
Extreme heat	Shade + safe drinking water where appropriate.	Monitor closely and seek help if severe.
Heavy rain / wet exposure	Dry, sheltered, well-drained space.	Check for chilling, illness and hygiene problems.
Cold / exposed calf	Dry bedding + wind protection + suitable shelter.	Ensure nutrition and veterinary care as needed.
Possible abandonment	Do not simply relocate the animal.	Arrange responsible rescue, ownership resolution or shelter placement.

9. A MESSAGE OF DHARMA & COMPASSION

For viewers who approach animal welfare through the idea of dharma, compassion can be expressed through practical responsibility: seeing suffering, refusing unnecessary cruelty, and taking a constructive step within one's capacity. The message is about responsible care and lawful action, not hostility toward any person or community.

Think about the calf. Think about the systems around it. Then choose one safe, constructive action.

**SAVE LIFE • SERVE WITH COMPASSION
• ACT RESPONSIBLY**

Awareness guide only. This document does not replace veterinary diagnosis or professional legal advice. For urgent animal-health cases, contact a qualified veterinarian or appropriate local animal-welfare authority.